

to return to scouting. (Herald-Post Photo by Bill Thompson.)

Bob Ingram

'As I Was Saying ...'

Wasiak in New Territory

IT WAS STAN WASIAK'S first trip ever to El Paso.

Whether he visioned us a sleepy town on the Rio Grande where the tumbleweeds blow, I don't know.

The new manager of the El Paso Sun Dodgers hasn't seen enough of the city to know whether he's going to like it or not. But his warm welcome from the fans at Dudley Field last night should impress him. Maybe he'll like the town after he's been around awhile, even against Florida.

"I've never been to Albuquerque, either," said Wasiak, speaking of another Los Angeles Dodger farm city.

The new manager of The Sun Dodgers has been managing clubs for 23 years. A lot of it has been in the South.

He liked running the Daytona Beach club. His club drew well, he said, in competition with dog racing, jai alai, water sports and other Florida attractions.

Busy First Night Here

WASIAK WAS NEVER a big league player. He didn't even have half a cup of coffee in the majors as a player. He spent his minor league career playing second base mostly.

As a manager, he helped develop two players on the current Dodger team, Willic Davis and Jim Lefebvre. He also helped send Roger Craig, one of the Los Angeles Dodgers' leading pitchers in the past, to the big club.

"I'd like to coach in the big leagues," said Wasiak. "The pension benefit is great."

Wasiak called a clubhouse meeting of the Sun Dodgers and laid out some of his coaching philosophy and ground rules to them. Clubhouse meetings are off limits to the press but I do know he told his players that managers don't make ball players but that players make the manager.

He took charge of infield practice of the Sun Dodgers, relieving Andy Cohen who just had a tooth pulled and needed the rest.

On the coaching line last night, Wasiak had more movements with his hands than a hula girl. Not being a sign stealer, I wouldn't know what if anything he was telling the batter, which signs were decoys or which ones meant absolutely nothing.